Dear Hiring Team at Halden Pay,

I am applying for the Senior Data Engineer – Data Platform role. With nine years of experience building and operating data platforms across payments and other data-intensive businesses, I bring hands-on experience with production pipelines, cloud warehouses, data modelling and the standards that help teams rely on their data.

At Lukovac Freight Hub, I own the ingestion layer of a platform with around 140 Airflow DAGs and have helped make its warehouse more reliable and efficient. I migrated approximately 300 stored procedures into more than 420 tested and documented dbt models, reducing the nightly build from 5 hours 10 minutes to 1 hour 35 minutes. I also introduced data contracts that reduced broken-pipeline incidents from around nine per month to two, and built a Kafka-based streaming pipeline handling around 30 million events per day. These experiences align closely with Halden Pay's focus on a shared, reusable data platform and clear data quality standards.

My previous role at Kovalent Pay gave me direct experience in payments data. I built PySpark jobs on AWS EMR to reconcile around 1.2 TB of daily files against internal ledgers, reducing the finance team's manual month-end reconciliation from about three days to four hours. I also designed a Redshift warehouse for finance and risk. Alongside this production work, I have contributed fixes and tests to an open-source Airflow provider, and I enjoy building tools and practices that make data work easier for other teams.

Halden Pay's work supporting businesses with international payments and trade-related financial needs is a strong match for my payments experience. I would welcome the opportunity to discuss how I could contribute to the Data Platform team.

Kind regards,
Lena Varga-Holm